

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF HOME AFFAIRS
RAJYA SABHA
UNSTARRED QUESTION NO.1596
TO BE ANSWERED ON THE 5TH FEBRUARY, 2014/MAGHA 16, 1935 (SAKA)

STUDY OF NDMA ABOUT STAMPEDE AT RELIGIOUS SHRINES

1596. SHRIMATI WANSUK SYIEM:

Will the Minister of HOME AFFAIRS be pleased to state:

- (a) whether prompted by the shocking incident of stampede at a temple in Madhya Pradesh in October last year killing 115 people the National Disaster Management Authority has commissioned a study by the IIM, Ahmedabad to prevent recurrence of such tragedies at religious shrines;
- (b) whether the study has revealed that most of the shrines frequented by devotees in large numbers are located atop hills or mountains with mostly uneven terrain and narrow winding up pathways; and
- (c) the salient features of the guidelines drawn by IIM study for better crowd management at religious shrines during festivals/melas?

ANSWER

MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF HOME AFFAIRS
(SHRI MULLAPPALLY RAMACHANDRAN)

(a): The study on crowd management was commissioned by NDMA before occurrence of an incident of stampede in Oct, 2013 at a temple in Madhya Pradesh. The Objective of the study is to prevent/mitigate such tragedies at religious and other venues of mass gathering.

(b): The study has pointed out that a large number of religious sites in the country are located atop hills/mountains with difficult terrain.

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(c): The Document "Crowd Management" provides guidance on "preparation and planning" to event Administrators and Organisers for safe conduct of events and venues involving mass gathering. It also provides a format of event approval application which can be used by the local licensing / approving authorities. Crowd Management guide document suggest following:-

- Undertake Hazards, risk and vulnerability assessment;
- Prepare crowd management plan covering components viz. – Safety and security, Emergency medical services, Transportation and traffic management, information gathering dissemination, lost and found, evacuation and shelter, crowd management and EoC-operation.
- Collaborative planning involving organisers, administrator, surrounding community, local and district disaster management authority etc.
